

Fixings, support and disassembly

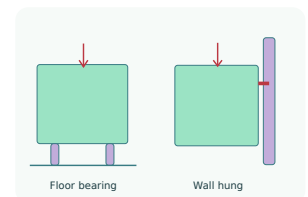
Support design starts with load paths, the supporting substrate and access for service. Distinguish bearing support from restraint without turning a sketch into a universal fixing prescription.

What you will accomplish

- Trace load paths and support type
- Identify the substrate and fixing system
- Plan service access before closure

Trace load paths and support type

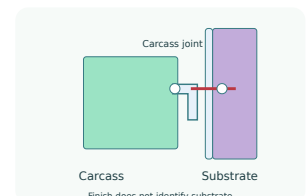
A floor-standing unit transfers weight through its parts and base or legs to the floor. A wall-hung unit transfers it through carcass connections and suspension to the wall. These paths define the review scope, not adequacy. Distinguish vertical weight from a user pull at a handle and identify bearing and restraint points for each use case.



Floor-bearing and wall-hung load paths differ.

Identify the substrate and fixing system

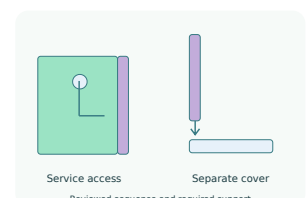
Paint or tile does not identify the load-bearing substrate. Document its construction, condition and concealed services using site information. The detail must show carcass, support member, carcass-to-support connection and support-to-substrate connection. Fixing type, number, size and location require system-specific technical review; this lesson provides planning, not drilling instructions.



Review both carcass-to-support and support-to-substrate connections.

Plan service access before closure

A cover may hide adjustment or fixing points; define access without destroying finishes. Draw cover removal and service sequence, identifying any temporary support needed in a competent specialist's plan. Do not treat a load-carrying connection as a freely removable cover. Retain system references, fixing locations and inspection records with approved maintenance instructions.



Service access must preserve the required support plan.

Worked case and decision

Option A shows a screw into a finish without identifying its substrate. B shows carcass, support, substrate and both connections, flagging load and substrate information for review. B is a more complete review package because it exposes the load path and unknowns; it is not installation approval.

Decision: develop B as a review package; do not issue it for installation before technical verification.

Check understanding

What is missing when the sketch shows a fixing only into the finish?

- Substrate identity and connection chain
- Cover colour only
- Image title

Correct: Substrate identity and connection chain. The finish does not identify the supporting substrate or complete connection chain.

Lesson questions

Can any connector be removed for access?

No. Review its load-carrying role and specialist support/disassembly plan first.

Practice

Submit floor-standing/wall-hung load paths, a support detail and a substrate/service review list.

Load paths

Connection-chain detail

Verification and service information

Review your work against the criteria. Saving it does not constitute technical project approval.

- Substrate identified beyond finish
- Both connections shown
- No guessed fixing specification